
ALLERGY SKIN TESTS
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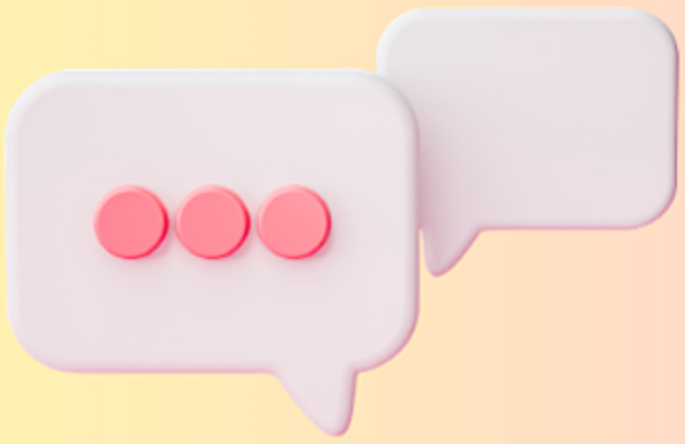


TYPES OF TESTS:



1. Drops of allergen extracts are placed on your forearm or back, and the skin is lightly pricked or scratched so the liquid enters the surface. Results appear in 15 to 20 minutes.
2. Intradermal Test: A small amount of allergen is injected just under the skin if a prick test is inconclusive or for specific allergies like insect stings.
3. Patch Test: Patches containing allergens are taped to your back for a week with multiple check-ups to diagnose contact dermatitis.





WHAT TO EXPECT?



- Preparation: You must stop taking antihistamines and certain other medications days before your test, as they block skin reactions.
- The Test: The nurse or doctor cleans the skin, labels test spots, and applies the extracts with tiny, painless lancets.
- Results: A positive reaction looks like a raised, red, itchy bump (similar to a mosquito bite) and is measured on the spot.





IMPORTANT PRECAUTIONS:



- Stop Certain Medications: Avoid antihistamines, tricylic antidepressants, and heartburn medications for 5 to 7 days before testing, as they can affect results. Always check with your doctor first!
- Do not apply lotions, creams, perfumes, or tanning products to the test area on the day of the procedure.
- Avoid scratching or touching the test area during the 15 minute wait to prevent skin damage or cross-contamination
- Post-Patch Test Care: Avoid showers, swimming, and rigorous exercises that cause heavy sweating, as moisture can loosen the patches





WHY IT'S DONE?



Information from allergy tests may help a healthcare professional develop an allergy treatment plan that includes allergen avoidance, medicines or allergy shots, called immunotherapy.

Allergy skin tests are widely used to help diagnose allergic conditions, including: Hay fever, also called allergic rhinitis, Allergic asthma, Dermatitis, called eczema, Food allergies, Penicillin allergy, Bee venom allergy.

